

Daily Bible Note

Date: September 22, 2026

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: 1 Chronicles 13:1-8

1 Then David consulted with the captains of thousands and hundreds, and with every leader.

2 And David said to all the assembly of Israel, "If it seems good to you, and if it is of the LORD our God, let us send out to our brethren everywhere who are left in all the land of Israel, and with them to the priests and Levites who are in their cities and their common-lands, that they may gather together to us;

3 and let us bring the ark of our God back to us, for we have not inquired at it since the days of Saul."

4 Then all the assembly said that they would do so, for the thing was right in the eyes of all the people.

5 So David gathered all Israel together, from Shihor in Egypt to as far as the entrance of Hamath, to bring the ark of God from Kirjath Jearim.

6 And David and all Israel went up to Baalah, to Kirjath Jearim, which belonged to Judah, to bring up from there the ark of God the LORD, who dwells between the cherubim, where His name is proclaimed.

7 So they carried the ark of God on a new cart from the house of Abinadab, and Uzza and Ahio drove the cart.

8 Then David and all Israel played music before God with all their might, with singing, on harps, on stringed instruments, on tambourines, on cymbals, and with trumpets.

II. Key Summary

- David consulted with the captains of thousands and hundreds and every leader, proposing to gather Israelites from everywhere, along with the priests and Levites, to bring back the ark of God, because they had not inquired at it during Saul's reign (vv. 1–3).

- The whole assembly agreed, and David gathered people from Shihor in Egypt in the south to the entrance of Hamath in the north, going up to Kirjath Jearim to bring the ark (vv. 4–6).
 - They carried the ark out of Abinadab's house on a new cart driven by Uzza and Ahio, while David and all Israel played music before God with all their might, singing with harps, tambourines, cymbals, and trumpets (vv. 7–8).
-

III. Passage Analysis

David's First Move as King: Putting God Back at the Center

David said not, "What pompous thing shall I do now?" or, "What pleasant thing?" but, "What pious thing?" ... Those are likely to proceed in the favour of God who thus begin in the fear of God. [1]

David had just settled into power, and the first thing on his mind wasn't enjoying it — it was bringing the ark, the sign of God being with His people, back to the center of everyone's life. Under Saul, God had been pushed aside, and David wanted a fresh start right there.

A Shiny New Cart Can't Replace God's Way

David's heart in seeking God was right; carrying the ark on a "new cart" was the greatest honor he knew how to give. But serving God takes not only the right attitude, but also the right method. Serving God our own way can only satisfy people; only serving Him His way can satisfy God. [2]

David brought out the newest, best cart for God, and the music was loud and joyful — it looked perfect. But God had already said how the ark should be carried. Good intentions and a big celebration can't replace first asking God what He says.

IV. Reflection Question

The last time you decided to do something that "seemed like the right thing," whose opinion did you ask first? Did you stop to inquire of God about it?

David consulted every leader and the whole assembly said yes, yet the ark ended up on

a new cart — everyone agreeing isn't the same as God agreeing; doing it God's way is what makes a good thing truly pleasing to Him.

References

[1] Blue Letter Bible, Matthew Henry's Commentary (1 Chronicles 13),
https://www.blueletterbible.org/comm/mhc/1Ch/1Ch_013.cfm

[2] Chinese Christian Bible Study Website (華人基督徒查經資料網站),
《歷代志上聖經綜合解讀》 (1 Chronicles 13 Notes),
<https://www.ccbiblestudy.org/Old%20Testament/13%20Chro/13GT13.htm>